



ROMAN LIFE

The Romans planned their towns to include magnificent public buildings such as temples, the town hall, baths, and places of entertainment. There were also grand houses for wealthy families. But side by side with these were the tumbledown dwellings where most people lived—overcrowded apartments built over shops and workshops. The poor had no kitchens, so they lived on bread or bought hot food from stalls. Since the Romans lived, traded, and ate in the streets, their towns were noisy places. Traffic was bad, too, with carts and wagons bringing country goods through the busy streets.

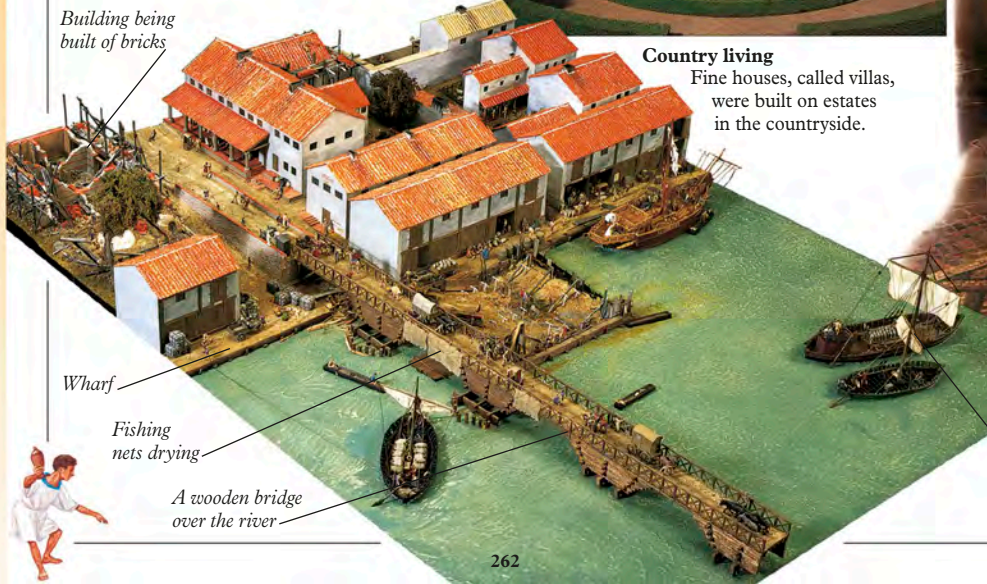
In the kitchen

This scene shows what a typical Roman kitchen was like. You would have found it in the town house or villa of a rich family.



Country living

Fine houses, called villas, were built on estates in the countryside.



Building being built of bricks

Wharf

Fishing nets drying

A wooden bridge over the river